



CANDIDATE – PLEASE NOTE!

PRINT your name on the line below and return this booklet with your answer sheet. Failure to do so may result in disqualification.

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MAY/JUNE 2016

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

**CARIBBEAN SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE®
EXAMINATION**

ENGLISH A

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

1 hour 30 minutes

17 MAY 2016 (p.m.)

READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY.

1. This test consists of 60 items. You will have 1 hour and 30 minutes to answer them.
2. In addition to this test booklet, you should have an answer sheet.
3. Each item in this test has four suggested answers lettered (A), (B), (C), (D). Read each item you are about to answer and decide which answer is best.
4. On your answer sheet, find the number which corresponds to your item and shade the space having the same letter as the answer you have chosen. Look at the sample item below.

Sample Item

Choose the word or set of words that **BEST** completes each sentence.

Someone who is suffering from influenza needs to be isolated as the disease is _____

- (A) lasting
- (B) serious
- (C) contagious
- (D) destructive

Sample Answer

(A) (B) ☒ (C) (D)

The best answer to this item is “contagious”, so (C) has been shaded.

5. If you want to change your answer, erase it completely before you fill in your new choice.
6. When you are told to begin, turn the page and work as quickly and as carefully as you can. If you cannot answer an item, go on to the next one. You may return to that item later.

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

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Items 1-5

Instructions: Each sentence has either one or two words missing. Choose from the four options the word or pair of words which BEST completes the meaning of the sentence. Mark your choice on the answer sheet.

- | | |
|---|--|
| <p>1. Despite his short-temper, his willingness to give of his wealth to help others to succeed led people to call him</p> <p>(A) hasty
(B) foolish
(C) benevolent
(D) old fashioned</p> | <p>4. While the committee members insults across the floor, the chairman tried in vain to order.</p> <p>(A) hurled restore
(B) spoke impose
(C) gave maintain
(D) exchanged conserve</p> |
| <p>2. When parents display a for one child, the others are likely to feel</p> <p>(A) fondness ... lonely
(B) dislike ... indifferent
(C) preference ... jealous
(D) concern ... angry</p> | <p>5. To conceal his true activities, the spy quickly a plausible excuse for his presence there.</p> <p>(A) fabricated
(B) divulged
(C) explained
(D) disguised</p> |
| <p>3. An attack on someone when that person is most vulnerable may be but is always</p> <p>(A) inappropriate thoughtful
(B) rewarding satisfying
(C) destructive distressing
(D) effective unkind</p> | |

Items 6–10

Instructions: Some of the sentences in this section are unacceptable because of inappropriate grammar, idiom or vocabulary. Some sentences are acceptable as they stand. No sentence contains more than one inappropriate element.

Choose the ONE underlined part A, B or C that is inappropriate. If the sentence is acceptable as it stands, choose D.

6. There is hardly a point to our knocking as no one is not at home. No error
A B C D
7. Had they not been forewarned, they might have joined the queue, not knowing that gas was not
A B C
on sale at that station. No error.
D
8. The problem with the students is that they arrive late, gives no excuse, and are rude when spoken
A B C
to. No error.
D
9. June prefers to lie in bed not wanting to go to school nor does any work. No error.
A B C D
10. The biased reporter is concerned not so much with the truth of what he writes, as with its credibility.
A B C
No error
D

Items 11–15

Instructions: Each sentence in this section is followed by four sentences A, B, C and D. Choose the one NEAREST IN MEANING to the original sentence.

11. The news shocked me so much that I almost forgot what I wanted to say.
- (A) The news was so shocking that I could not move.
(B) I could hardly remember my message after such shocking news.
(C) I nearly didn't speak again after the shock of the news.
(D) I was so shocked by the news that I could hardly speak.
12. If students' efforts are rewarded they would be encouraged to work harder.
- (A) Students must be encouraged to work hard.
(B) If students work harder, they will be praised for their effort.
(C) Students whose efforts are compensated generally work better.
(D) If students are praised for their efforts, they usually work harder.
13. No right thinking person who has lived in the country will fail to understand my disgust at noise.
- (A) Every right thinking person will understand my disgust at noise in the country.
(B) Noise in the country is as disgusting to me as it is to all right thinking people.
(C) My disgust at noise will be understood by any right thinking person who has lived in the country.
(D) It is inconceivable that a right thinking person in the country could fail to understand my disgust at noise.
14. The youth of the country need to organize themselves into cooperatives in order to support the prime minister's drive for self-sufficiency.
- (A) Cooperatives are the only means by which the prime minister's plan for self-sufficiency could be achieved by the youth.
(B) The youth should show their support for the prime minister's plans for self-sufficiency by organizing themselves into cooperatives.
(C) The prime minister advised the youth to get into cooperative groups so that they could support his plan for self-sufficiency.
(D) In order to support the plan for self-sufficiency the youth need to organize themselves and cooperate with the prime minister.
15. The Europeans who were not well off were those who came to the West Indies in search of wealth.
- (A) Europeans settled in the West Indies because they were told that they would become richer.
(B) Unemployment at home caused Europeans to come to the West Indies to seek their fortune.
(C) Financial difficulties at home made Europeans who came to the West Indies decide to settle there.
(D) Europeans who came to the West Indies to seek their fortunes were the ones who were not wealthy.

Items 16–20

Instructions: Select the option A, B, C or D that BEST describes EACH of the sentences and mark your choice on the answer sheet.

- (A) The sentence is too wordy, that is, repetitive or contains redundancies.
 - (B) The sentence contains clichés or misused metaphors.
 - (C) The sentence is incorrect grammatically or faulty in diction.
 - (D) The sentence is acceptable as it stands.
-
- 16. He advanced a step or two to meet his attacker who suddenly became alarmed and retreated back four or five paces.
 - 17. Traffic bottlenecks must be ironed out if we are to prevent giant traffic congestion.
 - 18. The politician hammered the nail of his argument into the leafy minds of his audience who had come to hear him speak on the difficult subject of monetary policy.
 - 19. Seldom do people declare that they are not the products of their environment.
 - 20. The modern approach to fitness is to adopt a holistic approach: physical, mental and emotional.

Items 21–30

Instructions: Read the following poem carefully and then answer Items 21–30 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

An Even Shape

Her garden looks in through my window
Criss-crossed by the white lattice.
Coolers they call them but they are also
Hiding places for small girls playing

- 5 Her garden stands neatly round her house
Travels politely unto the verandah
To sit in pots or hang
Leafily down from large, earth-coloured
urns
- 10 She lives with Mama, shepherding her with
her full body
The hesitant ins and outs of Mama's half-
blind days
Feeding her frail consciousness with edited
15 Gleaner news
And homemade chicken soup.

In her home, borrowed children touched her
china birds with hands
Wiped clean from eating sticky cakes, each
20 with a cherry on top
Or press moist, breathless kisses round
The corners of her smile.

- Sometimes she fills the space out
With music. Spreading out nostalgia through
25 Strings and flutes, old fashioned love songs
Of blue moons and forever until.

- Shameful peeping Tom, I sit silent in
My lattice watching the even shape of her
days
30 To catch, just once, a wider open door
behind
Her steady eyes.

- But in her green edged privacy, self-con-
tained
35 She keeps the half-drawn shutters of her life
Open just so, and mocks my greed and rest-
lessness
With a calm refusal to be other than she
seems.

21. The phrase "Her garden looks" (line 1) is an example of
(A) Simile
(B) Metaphor
(C) Sarcasm
(D) Personification
22. The garden seemed "criss-crossed" (line 2) because the
(A) poet was looking at it through a lattice window
(B) garden beds were laid out in squares
(C) children were walking across the garden
(D) the person looking at the garden was cross-eyed
23. Which of the following phrases is meant to be taken literally?
(A) "Hiding places for small girls" (line 4)
(B) "Her garden ... / Travels politely unto the verandah" (lines 5–6)
(C) "Feeding her frail consciousness" (line 14)
(D) "... watching the even shape of her days" (lines 28–29)
24. "Her garden stands neatly round her house" (line 5) tells us that
(A) there were several well-kept potted plants on stands around her house
(B) several tall trees stood along the side of the house
(C) the garden which surrounded the house was well kept
(D) the woman cleaned the flower stands every day

25. The poet uses the words “frail consciousness” (line 14) to show that Mama
- (A) was unconscious most of the time
 - (B) was not understanding as well as she used to
 - (C) had fainted because of lack of food
 - (D) was thin and weak and could hardly walk
26. Which of the following BEST describes the woman’s extra thoughtfulness of her mother?
- (A) “She lives with Mama, shepherding her with / Her full body” (lines 10–11)
 - (B) “Press moist, breathless kisses” (line 21)
 - (C) “Feeding her ... with edited Gleaner news” (lines 14–15)
 - (D) “Spreading out nostalgia through Strings and flutes” (lines 24–25)
27. The poet uses the phrase “borrowed children” (line 17) to show
- (A) how much she loved the children
 - (B) that she had no children of her own
 - (C) that she did not want children
 - (D) why she made the children wash their dirty hands
28. Which of the following were done by the children to show their love for the woman?
- I. Wiping their hands before touching the china bird
 - II. Eating all the sticky cakes she made them
 - III. Kissing her on the side of her lips
- (A) I and II only
 - (B) I and III only
 - (C) II and III only
 - (D) I, II and III
29. Lines 23–26 suggest that the woman
- (A) loved to play loud music
 - (B) was a musician in an orchestra
 - (C) enjoyed listening to happy music which tells of love
 - (D) spread all the musical instruments around the house
30. The word “nostalgia” (line 24) tells us that the music
- (A) would last forever
 - (B) was played on strings and flute
 - (C) reminded us that the moon was once blue
 - (D) brought back pleasant memories of long ago

Items 31–38

Instructions: Read the following passage carefully and then answer Items 31–38 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

Kino and Juana came to the place where the brush houses stopped and the city of stone and plaster began, the city of harsh outer walls and inner cool gardens where a little water played and the bougainvillea crusted the walls with purple and brick-red and white. They heard from the secret gardens the singing of caged birds and heard the splash of cooling water on hot flagstones.

5 The procession crossed the blinding plaza and passed in front of the church. It had grown now, and in the outskirts the hurrying newcomers were being softly informed how the baby had been stung by a scorpion, how the father and mother were taking it to the doctor.

And the newcomers, particularly the beggars from the front of the church who were great experts in financial analysis, looked quickly at Juana's old blue skirt, saw the tears in her shawl,

10 appraised the green ribbon on her braids, read the age of Kino's blanket and the thousand washings of his clothes, and set them down as poverty people and went along to see what kind of drama might develop. The four beggars in front of the church knew everything in the town. They were students of the expressions of young women as they went in to confession, and they saw them as they came out and read the nature of the sin. They knew every little scandal and some very big

15 crimes. They slept at their posts in the shadow of the church so that no one crept in for consolation without their knowledge. And they knew the doctor. They knew his ignorance, his cruelty, his avarice, his appetites, his sins. They knew his clumsy abortions and the little brown pennies he gave sparingly for alms.

They had seen his corpses go into the church. And, since early Mass was over and business

20 was slow, they followed the procession, these endless searchers after perfect knowledge of their fellowmen, to see what the fat, lazy doctor would do about an indigent baby with a scorpion bite.

The scurrying procession came at last to the big gate in the wall of the doctor's house. They could hear the splashing of the water and the singing of caged birds and the sweep of the long brooms on the flagstones. And they could smell the frying of good bacon from the doctor's

25 house.

Kino hesitated a moment. This doctor was not of his people. This doctor was of a race which for nearly four hundred years had beaten and starved and robbed and despised Kino's race, and frightened it too, so that the indigent came humbly to the door. And as always when he came near to one of this race, Kino felt weak and afraid and angry at the same time. Rage and terror went

30 together. He could kill the doctor more easily than he could talk to him, for all of the doctor's race spoke to all of Kino's race as though they were simple animals. And as Kino raised his right hand to the iron ring knocker in the gate, rage swelled in him, and the pounding music of the enemy beat in his ears, and his lips drew tight against his teeth but with his left hand he reached to take off his hat. The iron ring pounded against the gate. Kino took off his hat and stood waiting. Coyotito

35 moaned a little in Juana's arms, and she spoke softly to him. The procession crowded close the better to see and hear.

*John Steinbeck, The Pearl,
Penguin Books Ltd; 1973, pp. 9–10.*

31. The writer uses “secret” (line 4) to describe the gardens because
- (A) they were hidden from view
 - (B) many treasures were concealed there
 - (C) the occupants whispered there
 - (D) many people did not know of them
32. The word “procession” (line 5) indicates that the crowd was
- (A) going to a funeral
 - (B) moving in a long orderly group
 - (C) walking together like a mob
 - (D) moving about aimlessly
33. Which of the following statements is NOT true about the beggars?
- (A) They were inquisitive about people.
 - (B) They knew about human nature.
 - (C) They had a good relationship with the doctor.
 - (D) They knew everything that went on around them.
34. In the passage, the expression “great experts in financial analysis” (lines 8–9) means that the beggars
- (A) could immediately determine the rich from the poor
 - (B) could analyse the financial state of the country
 - (C) were able to add their alms quickly
 - (D) had many years of experience in begging
35. The description in paragraph 2 (lines 8–18) conveys to the reader the impression of
- (A) fear and hatred
 - (B) happiness and love
 - (C) harshness and poverty
 - (D) comfort and prosperity
36. According to the passage, “Kino hesitated a moment” (line 26) because he
- (A) had to calm his anger and hatred
 - (B) was afraid to approach the doctor
 - (C) wondered whether he had enough money
 - (D) wanted to kill the doctor with his bare hands
37. In the passage, the sentence, “This doctor was not of his people” (line 26) suggests that the doctor
- (A) did not respect Kino’s people
 - (B) did not understand Kino’s people
 - (C) was not born in the city as Kino was
 - (D) came from a different background from Kino’s
38. Which of the following is NOT illustrated in the passage?
- (A) The kindness of the beggars
 - (B) The curiosity of the city people
 - (C) The suffering of Juana and Kino
 - (D) The contrast between the rich and the poor

Items 39–46

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer Items 39–46 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

More than a quarter century ago, we were forced to wrestle with the thorny issue of casinos and the supposed ills and benefits which flow from them. In the end, a sensible solution emerged; allow some to remain while controlling their growth. Interestingly, we may argue about casinos, but we have given the green light to arcades where people gamble — day and night.

- 5 Some Caribbean governments have seemingly opened the door to yet another round of possible emotional debate with the decision to allow cruise ships lying at anchor to operate their casinos in their waters. Is this move a prelude to opening casinos on land?

- 10 Supporters of casino gambling have always said that casinos can and do function in a country without the moral decay that is routinely associated with them. Like most things, the pros and the cons about casino gambling are grossly exaggerated.

- 15 Those who favour them argue that casinos on land should be seen as another attraction that can be added to the country's tourism industry, if prudent controls are imposed. For example, The Bahamas, Antigua, Suriname and Sint Maarten are a few places where casino gambling is allowed and tourism authorities in those places have said that casino gambling has proven to be a stimulus to their tourism sector, without the moral decay that is routinely associated with them.

- 20 Opponents, on the other hand, insist that casinos lead to gambling addiction, crime, and worse a debasement of society. With everything else that is happening in our islands — an upsurge of gangs, drugs and violent behaviour among our youth — that is the last thing that we may need right now. However, the case of the cruise ships keeping casinos open while docked on shore may cause little if any harm to the country and its people since few locals will have access to them.

Let's face it, Caribbean people gamble at bingo to raise money for churches, they flock to the tracks to watch horses run and bet millions annually on the outcome of the races. Many play lotto daily and the English football pools weekly.

- 25 So if, as some are saying, this move of allowing gambling on cruise ships in port may be the first step to casinos on land, then we will not be totally surprised.

So let the debates begin.

*"Are Casinos Becoming a Reality?" Daily Nation,
26 April, 2010, p. 8.*

39. Casinos and their effect on society became an issue for the first time about

- (A) ten years ago
- (B) less than five years ago
- (C) over twenty-five years ago
- (D) one hundred years ago

40. How was the issue of casinos dealt with at the time mentioned?

- (A) Casinos were not allowed.
- (B) Many casinos remained without being monitored.
- (C) Most casinos remained while their growth was monitored.
- (D) Some casinos remained while their growth was monitored.

41. “Interestingly” (line 3) could BEST be replaced by the word
- (A) logically
 - (B) ironically
 - (C) thankfully
 - (D) conveniently
42. “given the green light to arcades” (line 4) means that
- (A) arcades have been given permission to operate
 - (B) gambling is practised in the arcades
 - (C) people gamble day and night under the light
 - (D) green coloured lights have been given to the arcades
43. The Bahamas, Antigua, Suriname and Sint Maarten are mentioned to
- (A) list countries involved in tourism
 - (B) give evidence from experts on the issue
 - (C) prove that gambling is a stimulus to tourism
 - (D) highlight countries where gambling is allowed
44. An expression the writer uses to introduce an opposing view (line 16) is
- (A) in addition
 - (B) for example
 - (C) like most things
 - (D) on the other hand
45. Which argument below is NOT used in support of casino gambling?
- (A) It degrades the values of society.
 - (B) It can be beneficial if controlled wisely.
 - (C) It can be used as another tourist attraction.
 - (D) It is part of the everyday life of the Caribbean individual.
46. To what does “... that is the last thing that we may need right now” (lines 18–19) refer?
- (A) “everything else that is happening in our islands” (line 17)
 - (B) “an upsurge of gangs, drugs and violent behaviour among our youth” (lines 17–18)
 - (C) “cruise ships keeping casinos open while docked on shore” (line 19)
 - (D) “they flock to the tracks to watch horses run and bet millions annually” (lines 21–22)

Items 47–54

Instructions: Read the following passage carefully and then answer Items 47–54 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

MUSIC TOO LOUD, I CAN'T STUDY

THE EDITOR: I just can't take it anymore. I just can't take the noise forced on me by a restaurant and bar located across the street. The noise is unbearable and I cannot concentrate on my studies. I am writing the CXC exams in May/June this year and I must pass all my subjects. I am attending a reputable girls' school and I want to make good grades to get into the CAPE class. I work hard and every report so far indicates that I am an above-average student.

I want to make my mother proud. She is a hard-working woman, especially since my father passed away two years ago. We have been struggling to make ends meet without complaint. But I must complain now because the restaurant and bar is intent on frustrating my ambitions and the sacrifices my mother is making. I appreciate the help of the Government in providing opportunities for education but this is going to be futile unless it is possible to take full advantage of them. Can you imagine having to struggle with a Math problem with thunderous noise bombarding your eardrums and everything in the house jumping up and down as if the place is haunted? Can you imagine speaking to a classmate about homework and you can't hear each other? Can you imagine stuffing cotton in your ears in order to get some sleep? Can you imagine trying to explain to your teacher that you didn't do your homework or that you sleep in class because of the noise coming from the restaurant and bar?

The noise coming from this place is a serious obstacle that I am unable to overcome and I am seeking help in dealing with it.

Can you imagine my mother and her 16-year-old daughter going to this place in the midst of riotous drinking to ask them to turn down the music because I want to study or just to get some sleep? I understand that residents have been calling the police but the response has been ineffective. At the moment of writing this letter (Sunday 19, at 9:30 a.m.) they are blasting away after going late into last night.

Under the guise of Carnival they will continue their merciless onslaught. From Carnival Friday night right up until Ash Wednesday morning they will continue non-stop. There will be total madness.

*"Music too loud, I Can't Study", Newsday
23 February, 2008.*

47. "I just can't take it anymore" (line 1) implies that the writer is

- (A) crying
- (B) arguing
- (C) hurting
- (D) shouting

48. The effect that is created by the repetition of "I" in the first paragraph can be BEST described as highlighting the writer's

- (A) view
- (B) voice
- (C) protest
- (D) frustration

49. Which of the following language devices does the writer use MOST in paragraph 2 to explain her plight?
- (A) Pun
 - (B) Contrast
 - (C) Repetition
 - (D) The rhetorical question
50. Which of the following words BEST conveys the emotion that the writer is seeking to arouse in the reader?
- (A) Love
 - (B) Anger
 - (C) Horror
 - (D) Empathy
51. The sentence “I work hard and every report so far indicates that I am an above-average student” (line 5) suggests that the writer
- (A) is boastful
 - (B) is pleading
 - (C) wants to sustain this performance
 - (D) is about to fail her examinations
52. “... jumping up and down as if the place is haunted”(line 12) is an example of which of the following devices?
- (A) Irony
 - (B) Hyperbole
 - (C) Paradox
 - (D) Personification
53. What effect does the writer achieve when she says “Can you imagine my mother and her 16-year-old daughter going to this place in the midst of riotous drinking” (lines 19–20)?
- (A) Criticism for their actions in going to a bar
 - (B) Surprise that the women should hesitate to go there
 - (C) Admiration from the reader for the women’s courage
 - (D) Scorn for the women’s behaviour in going into a bar
54. The last line of the passage expresses the view that
- (A) Carnival will be more festive
 - (B) the noisy atmosphere will become worse
 - (C) the writer will become hysterical
 - (D) the writer’s mother will quarrel with the restaurant owner

Items 55–60

Read the following advertisement carefully and then answer Items 55–60 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

JOIN OUR CARIBBEAN MILES PROGRAMME

You can earn Caribbean Airline Miles every flight; plus when you fly, drive or shop, you will earn Miles even faster.

OUR MEMBERSHIP:

- Members who fly 20 000 miles on Caribbean Airlines within a calendar year are eligible for a Silver Membership
- Flying 40 000 miles qualifies members for a Gold Membership, while flying 80 000 miles qualifies for an Executive Gold Membership

Silver Tier Membership

- Unique member's credentials
A 3000 Miles Bonus upon attainment of Silver Tier Status
- Preferential check-in and priority boarding on all Caribbean Airlines flights
- Waiver of date change penalty and redeposit fee on reward tickets

Gold Tier Membership

- Unique member's credentials
A 5000 Miles Bonus upon attainment of Gold Tier Status
- Preferential check-in and priority boarding on all Caribbean Airlines flights
- Waiver of date change penalty and redeposit fee on reward tickets
- Expedited award delivery at no cost

DESTINATION	AWARDS	MILES NEEDED
Within the Caribbean or between South America* and the Caribbean	One Way Upgrade	5 000
	One Way Economy Class	7 500
	One Way Business Class	12 000
Between the Caribbean/ South America* and North America	One Way Upgrade	10 000
	One Way Economy Class	15 500
	One Way Business Class	25 500
Between Kingston and North America	One Way Economy Class	16 250
	One Way Business Class	28 750

* South America refers to: Caracas, Georgetown & Paramaribo

Thank you for Flying with Caribbean Airlines.

Visit us at Caribbean-Airlines.Com or call us.
E-mail: miles@caribbean-airlines.com

Adapted from "Caribbean Miles", Caribbean Beat, No. 108 March/April 2011, Media and Education Projects Ltd, p. 91.

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55. What does this airline promise if a person joins the Miles Programme?
- (A) Faster travel
 - (B) Free shopping
 - (C) Frequent shopping
 - (D) Rewards for every flight
56. How many bonus miles does a Silver Tier Member receive?
- (A) 3 000
 - (B) 5 000
 - (C) 7 000
 - (D) 8 000
57. To which of the following destinations can a person fly using 25 500 airline miles?
- (A) Asia
 - (B) Africa
 - (C) Europe
 - (D) North America
58. According to the advertisement, what should a prospective member do if more detailed information is needed about the benefits of the programme?
- (A) Fly frequently
 - (B) Visit the airline's webpage
 - (C) Visit the airline offices
 - (D) Join the Miles Programme
59. Which technique does the advertisement use to appeal to travellers to join the Miles Programme?
- (A) Facts
 - (B) Opinion
 - (C) Persuasive language
 - (D) Personal experience
60. The MAIN purpose of the advertisement is to encourage persons to
- (A) enjoy air travel
 - (B) receive an executive Gold Card
 - (C) fly more often
 - (D) become members of the Miles Programme

END OF TEST

IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS TEST.